Claude VideoEffects: Step-by-Step Guide for porusai

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Whatthis is

One talking-head clip becomes many different edits, each made with a single /effects <name> command inside Claude Code. No editing app and no timeline are needed.

> The skill is a free, open-source add-on for Claude Code with 42 starter effects (orbit, spotlight, glass widgets, LED sign, carousel spin and more).
>
> Every effect tracks your face and puts its graphics behind you, so your face stays clear.
>
> The output is a new MP4 saved next to your original, with your original audio kept. It adds visuals only. Music, sound effects and captions are added afterwards (for example in CapCut).

What you need

Five things, all free. Claude can install the last three for you if they are missing.

Item	Why	How to get it
Claude Code	Runs the /effects command	Desktop app or terminal, signed in to your Claude account
A clip of you talking	The video the effects go on	A vertical phone video works best; 3 to 15 seconds is ideal
Git	Downloads the skill	Mac: comes with Xcode tools. Windows: winget install Git.Git
FFmpeg	Reads and writes video	Mac: brew install ffmpeg . Windows: winget install ffmpeg
Python 3.10 or newer	Runs the face tracking and effects	Mac: brew install python@3.12 . Windows: winget install Python.Python.3.12

A normal laptop is enough. There is no GPU requirement; a 4-second clip renders in about 1 to 3 minutes on a basic CPU.

Step 1:Installthe skill

Copy the repo into your Claude skills folder with one command, then restart Claude Code.

1. Open a terminal (Mac: Terminal app; Windows: PowerShell; or the terminal inside Claude Code).
2. Paste the line for your computer and press Enter.

   Mac / Linux: `git clone https://github.com/Vibha-Ramprakash/claude-video effects ~/.claude/skills/effects`

   Windows (PowerShell): `git clone https://github.com/Vibha Ramprakash/claude-video-effects $HOME\.claude\skills\effects`
3. Quit and reopen Claude Code so it picks up the new skill.
4. Check it worked: type `/effects` in Claude Code. It should show up as a command.

No terminal? Paste this into Claude Code instead and it will do the install for you: *Install the skill from github.com/Vibha-Ramprakash/claude-video-effects into ~/.claude/skills/effects*.

To update later, run `git pull` inside that `effects` folder.

Step 2: First-run setup

The first time you use `/effects` , Claude runs a one-time setup that takes 1 to 3 minutes and ends with the word READY.

1. Claude runs `bash scripts/setup.sh` from the skill folder. You do not need to type it yourself.
2. The script checks for FFmpeg and Python, makes a private Python environment in `effects/.venv` , and installs four packages: numpy, opencv-python, pillow and mediapipe.
3. It prints one of three results:

Message	Meaning	What happens next

READY	Everything is installed	Go to Step 3
NEED_FFMPEG	FFmpeg is missing	Claude installs it (`brew install ffmpeg` or `winget install ffmpeg`), then runs setup again
NEED_PYTHON	No Python 3.10+ found	Claude installs Python 3.12, then runs setup again

Setup only runs once. Later uses start straight away. On Windows the environment's Python lives at `.venv\Scripts\python.exe` instead of `.venv/bin/python` .

Step 3: Make your first effect

Drag your clip into Claude Code, type `/effects` plus an effect name and a time, and Claude renders `yourclip_effects.mp4` next to the original.

1. Open Claude Code and drag your video file into the chat (or paste its path). 2.

Type a command in plain words, for example:

> `/effects orbit from 1 to 4 seconds`
>
> `/effects spotlight with the word WATCH behind me`
>
> `/effects comment-box at the end, typing PORUS`
>
> `/effects liquid-glass-graph from 11K to 672K`

3. Claude saves 2 or 3 check frames first and looks at them. If text covers your face or is cut off, it fixes the settings before rendering.
4. Claude renders the full clip. The new file appears next to your original, with your original audio.
5. Watch it before you post. If something looks off, just say so ("the word covers my face", "make it slower") and Claude re-renders.

Timing tip: say it in words, such as *when I say "watch"*. Claude transcribes the clip and finds the exact second.

Step 4: Stack several effects in one clip

Ask for several effects in one message and Claude writes them into a small plan file, checks frames, then renders once.

1. Ask in plain words: *Add dot-reveal for the first half second, then carousel-spin until the end.*
2. Claude writes a plan next to your clip, named `<clip>_effects.json`:

```
{"effects": [
    {"fx": "dot-reveal", "start": 0, "end": 0.5},
    {"fx": "carousel-spin", "start": 0.5, "end": 3.6, "images": "my-reels folder"}
]}
```

3. Check frames (fast): Claude runs `scripts/fx.py --plan <plan> <clip> check.png --still 1.6,3.2` and looks at the PNGs.
4. Final render: `scripts/fx.py --plan <plan> <clip> <clip>_effects.mp4`. Add `--width 2160` for 4K (slower).

Effects run in the order listed. Put camera moves (`locked-on`, `lean-in`, `spotlight`) first when they overlap other effects.

One clip, many versions: make one plan per effect (for example `01_carousel-spin.json`, `02_match-cut.json`) and render each from the same clip. That is how a "1 clip, 7 edits" reel is built.

The effectlist

Type the name after `/effects`. All options are optional; text options split lines with `|`.

#	Name	What it does	Main options
1	`noise`	Reels pile up behind your head	`images`, `size`
2	`lineup`	Numbered tiles fan out above your head	`text`
3	`locked-on`	Brackets lock on your face; camera follows	`zoom`, `text`
4	`orbit`	Reels circle your head	`images`, `count`, `speed`

| # | Name | What it does | Main options |

5	lean-in	Fast punch-in on one word	zoom (max 2)
6	backdrop-word	Giant word drops in behind you	text , color , font
7	spotlight	Room goes dark, you stay lit	text , color , push
8	the-bill	Instructions print like a receipt	text
9	moody	Colour grade	grade (moody, bw, warm, cool, pop)
10	swipe	Before/after slider	grade
11	todo	Checklist beside your head ticks off	text , ticks , title
12	comment-box	Instagram comment types and posts	text , handle
13	tap	Follow button flips to Following	at , x , y
14	pause-point	Freeze frame with a drawn arrow	text , color
15	uninstall	Glitchy uninstall bar breaks the frame	text
16	reel-frame	Video shrinks into a reel card	text
17	shortcut-rain	Keyboard keys rain behind you	text , count
18	reject-stamp	Big red stamp slams down	text , color , angle
19	countdown-flip	3-2-1 flip clock above your head	from
20	rabbit-hole	Frame tunnels into itself	ratio , speed , spin
21	cover-star	You become a magazine cover	text , lines , issue , look=editorial
22	scribble	Marker doodles draw around you	text , color
23	glass-widgets	Frosted glass widgets float around your head	text , name , handle , look=simple

#	Name	What it does	Main options
24	red-collage	B&W you, giant red word behind	text , lines , tag

25	split-headline	Headline card pushes you down	text , hl , pill , pos=left
26	pastel-word	Lavender room, word behind, profile card	text , name , handle
27	check-pills	Grid-paper room, pills get clicked	text , images
28	timeline	Red film look with editing timeline	text , sub , tc
29	headline-box	Punch-in with two-line headline	text , zoom
30	profile-wall	Reels grid fills the wall, counter ticks	images , count , label
31	tier-list	Tier list drops, Claude lands in S tier	title , item , others
32	broll-split	B-roll on top with a price tag, you below	images , text
33	phone-fan	Reels fan out like a hand of phones	images , text
34	dot-reveal	Shot builds from glowing dots	color , cell
35	headline-wall	Headlines pile up behind your head	text , total , label
36	checklist	Task list under your chin ticks green	text , title
37	liquid-glass graph	Glass card, graph climbs, number counts up	text , from , to , look=bento
38	carousel-spin	Reels spin around you in 3D	images , count , turns
39	match-cut	News pages cut on one word	text , color

#	Name	What it does	Main options
40	apple-toggles	iPhone switches flip on one by one	text , ticks , pos
41	led-sign	Lights drop, LED sign types out	text , color , push

42	slow-push	Slow push-in, room blurs	zoom , blur

Bonus looks: glitter-spotlight (spotlight with gold rays and sparkles), cover-star look=editorial and liquid-glass-graph look=bento .

Tips for clean results

Short windows, real numbers and graphics that never sit on you make the difference.

Keep 1.5 to 4 seconds per effect. Longer windows feel slow on a reel.

Shoot vertical, framed chest-up, with space above your head. The effects place graphics above and around your head.

Graphics stay behind you. If a check frame shows a card, word or phone over your face or body, ask Claude to put it behind you or move it to the empty side of the frame. **Use your own reels.** For orbit , noise , phone-fan , carousel-spin and profile wall , give Claude a folder of your own screenshots or frames.

Use your real numbers and handle. Set text , from / to , name and handle (for example @porus_ai) so nothing shows a placeholder.

Zoom stays at 2x or less so the video stays sharp.

Add sound last. Music, sound effects and captions go on in CapCut or your editor after rendering.

Troubleshooting

Most problems are a missing tool, a stale terminal or a setting that needs a nudge; tell Claude what you see and it fixes it.

Problem	Fix
/effects does not appear	Restart Claude Code. Check the folder is exactly ~/.claude/skills/effects with SKILL.md inside

`git` not found (Windows)	`winget install Git.Git`, then open a new terminal
`ffmpeg` or `python` not found after installing	Close and reopen the terminal or Claude Code so it sees the new PATH
Setup stuck or failing on mediapipe	Use Python 3.10 to 3.12; very new Python versions may lack mediapipe builds
Text or a widget covers your face	Ask Claude to move it behind you, change `x` / `y`, or shorten the text
Text cut off at the frame edge	Shorten the line or ask for a smaller size
Strange characters (Â·) in text on Windows	Ask Claude to save the plan file with plain ASCII (escaped symbols)
Render is slow	Normal on a laptop CPU: about 1 to 3 minutes per 4-second clip at 1080p; skip 4K
Wide (16:9) clip looks crowded	The effects are tuned for vertical video; ask for graphics to sit in the empty side of the frame

License and source

The skill is open source under the MIT license, so it is free to use, change and share as long as its copyright notice stays with the code.

> Source: [claude-video-effects on GitHub] (MIT; copyright notice in its `LICENSE` file) Bundled parts keep their own licences: face tracking by OpenCV YuNet (MIT), person cut-out by MediaPipe Selfie Segmenter (Apache 2.0), and fonts under SIL OFL / Apache 2.0 (see the repo's `fonts/` folder).